much substitution is done on the literal's content. Literal strings are encoded using the source encoding of the file that contains them.

Single-quoted string literals ('_stuff_' and %q/_stuff_/) undergo the least substitution. They convert the sequence \\ into a single backslash, and a backslash can be used to escape the single quote or the string delimiter. All other backslashes appear literally in the string.

```
'hello'                       # => hello
'a backslash \'\\\''          # => a backslash '\'
%q/simple string/             # => simple string
%q(nesting (really) works)    # => nesting (really) works
%q(escape a\) with backslash) # => escape a) with backslash
%q no_blanks_here ;           # => no_blanks_here
```

Double-quoted strings ("_stuff_", %Q/_stuff_/, and %/_stuff_/) undergo additional substitutions; refer to the following table.

#{code}	Value of *code*	\b	Backspace (0x08)	\t	Tab (0x09)
\nnn	Octal *nnn*	\cx	Control-*x*	\uxxxx	Unicode character
\x	*x*	\e	Escape (0x1b)	\u{xx xx xx}	Unicode characters
\C-x	Control-*x*	\f	Formfeed (0x0c)	\v	Vertical tab (0x0b)
\M-x	Meta-*x*	\n	Newline (0x0a)	\xnn	Hex *nn*
\M-\C-x	Meta-control-*x*	\r	Return (0x0d)		
\a	Bell/alert (0x07)	\s	Space (0x20)		

Table 9—Substitutions in double-quoted strings

Here are some examples:

```
a  = 123
"\123mile"                    # => Smile
"Greek pi: \u03c0"            # => Greek pi: π
"Greek \u{70 69 3a 20 3c0}"   # => Greek pi: π
"Say \"Hello\""               # => Say "Hello"
%Q!"I said 'nuts'\!," I said! # => "I said 'nuts'!," I said
%Q{Try #{a + 1}, not #{a - 1}} # => Try 124, not 122
%<Try #{a + 1}, not #{a - 1}>  # => Try 124, not 122
"Try #{a + 1}, not #{a - 1}"   # => Try 124, not 122
%{ #{ a = 1; b = 2; a + b } }  # =>  3
```

Last, and probably least (in terms of usage), you can get the string corresponding to an ASCII character by preceding that character with a question mark, as outlined in the table that follows.

?a	a	ASCII character
?\n	\n	newline (0x0a)
?\C-a	\u0001	control a (0x65 & 0x9f) == 0x01
?\M-a	\xE1	meta sets bit 7
?\M-\C-a	\x81	meta and control a
?\C-?	\u007F	delete character

Inside a double-quoted string, the sequence #{EXPR} will cause the expression inside the curly braces to be evaluated, converted to a string, and interpolated into the string. If you